

Copying Disks

Making backup copies of your disks is simple. Just drag one disk onto another icon of the same type (for example, 3.5" disk to 3.5" disk). The Finder will ask you (via an alert) if it's OK to erase the contents of the disk you're copying to (the target disk) and replace them with the contents of the original disk (the source disk). If you click the "Replace" button (or press Return), the copy operation will begin. Since the two disks are the same size, an image (or disk-to-disk) copy is performed, making an exact copy of the disk very quickly.

If the two disks are of *different* sizes, the Finder will create a folder on the target disk (giving it the same name as the source disk) and copy the contents of the source disk into that folder. The copy proceeds one file at a time and is thus known as a file-by-file copy. No information is erased from the target disk; the contents of the source disk are *added* to the existing contents of the target disk. This makes it easy to copy a new program to a hard drive, where each program should be in a separate folder—in fact, it's virtually automatic.

Note!

Copying a disk file-by-file works best if the disk you're copying is smaller than the disk you're copying to. If you drag a larger disk onto a smaller disk, you probably won't have enough room on the target disk for all the contents of the source disk, but the Finder will attempt the copy operation anyway. (Your data won't be damaged; the Finder will merely cancel the copy when it figures out there's not enough room on the target disk to do your bidding.) And remember—3.5" disks hold more data (800K) than 5.25" disks (140K) even though they're smaller.

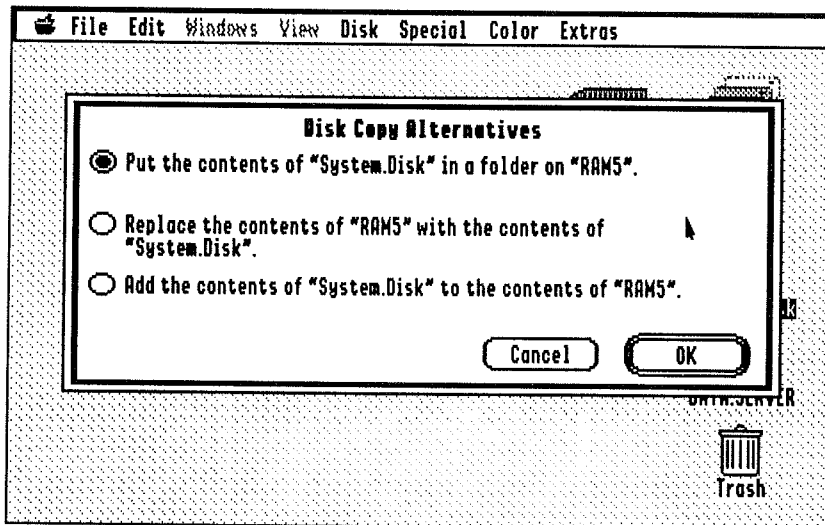


Figure 6D—Disk Copy Alternatives